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IT Project Management Support

Lecture 14

Managing People (3)

DISC Personality Types

Literature

- <https://www.discoveryreport.com/introduction-to-disc-personality-types.html>
- <https://discinsights.com/disc-theory>
- <https://www.discprofile.com/what-is-disc/overview/>
- https://psychology.wikia.org/wiki/DISC_assessment

DISC Model of Human Behavior

- The DISC personality test, based on Marston's DISC theory, has been used in business and personal applications for over 30 years.
- Just like creating infinite new colors by mixing together primary colors for painting, DISC personality uses these four basic personality traits of human behavior and every person has a very unique blend.
- It's the "color palette of the personality."
- The DISC Theory research that Marston conducted in the 1920's continues today to give us great insight into human behavior and DISC personality types.

DISC Assessment

The tests classify four aspects of personality by testing a person's preferences in word associations.

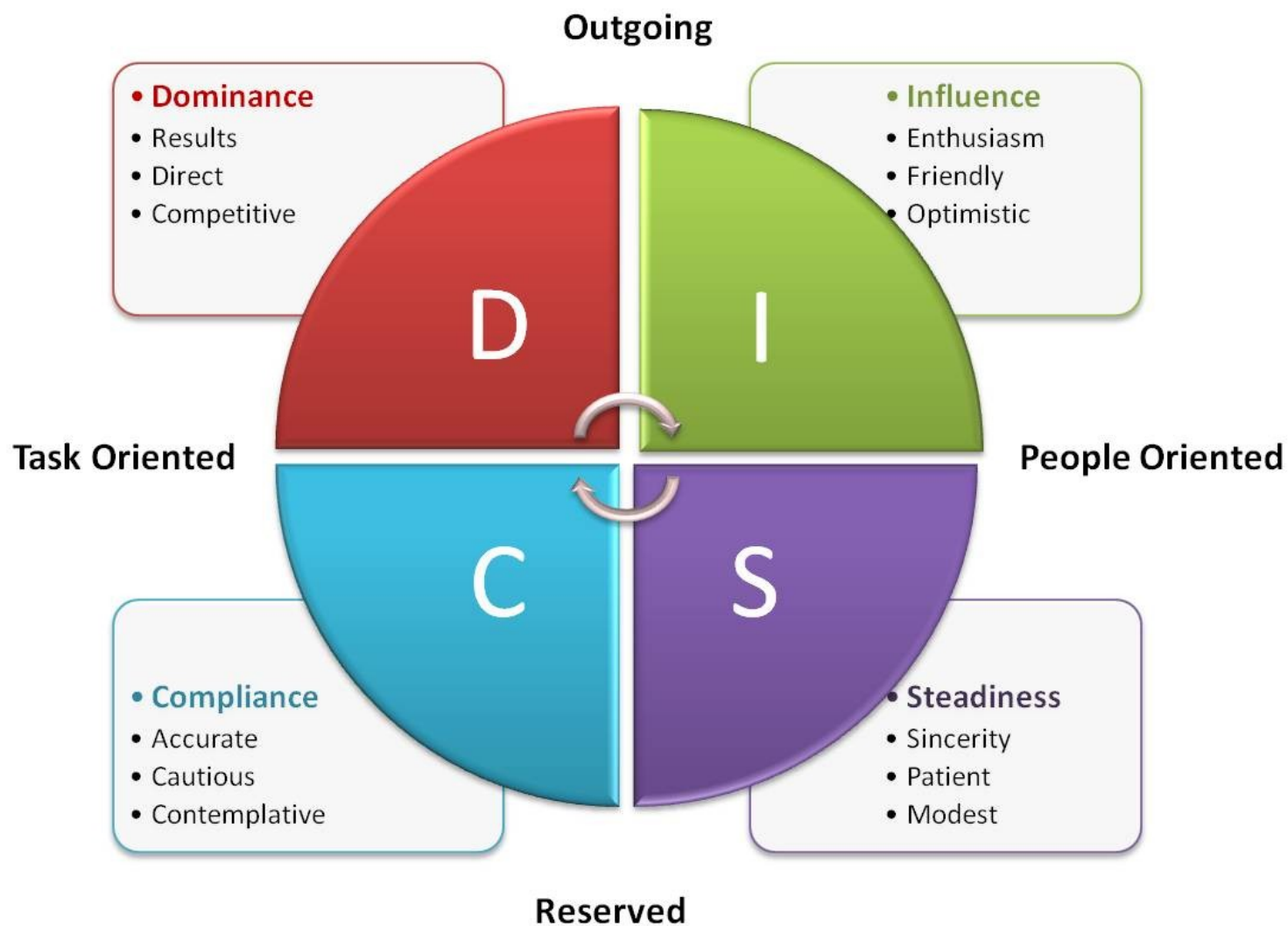
DISC is an acronym for:

- **Dominance** - relating to control, power and assertiveness
- **Influence** - relating to social situations and communication
- **Steadiness** - relating to patience, persistence, and thoughtfulness
- **Compliance** (or conscientiousness or caution) - relating to structure and organization

These four dimensions can be grouped in a grid with

- D and I sharing the top row and representing extroverted aspects of the personality,
- C and S below representing introverted aspects,
- D and C then share the left column and represent task-focused aspects,
- I and S share the right column and represent social aspects.

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Dominance

- People who score high in the intensity of the 'D' styles factor are very active in dealing with problems and challenges, while low D scores are people who want to do more research before committing to a decision.
- High "D" people are described as demanding, forceful, egocentric, strong willed, driving, determined, ambitious, aggressive, and pioneering.
- Low D scores describe those who are conservative, low keyed, cooperative, calculating, undemanding, cautious, mild, agreeable, modest and peaceful.

Influence

- People with High I scores influence others through talking and activity and tend to be emotional.
- They are described as convincing, magnetic, political, enthusiastic, persuasive, warm, demonstrative, trusting, and optimistic.
- Those with Low I scores influence more by data and facts, and not with feelings.
- They are described as reflective, factual, calculating, skeptical, logical, suspicious, matter of fact, pessimistic, and critical.
- .

Steadiness

- People with High S styles scores want a steady pace, security, and don't like sudden change.
- Low S intensity scores are those who like change and variety.
- High S persons are calm, relaxed, patient, possessive, predictable, deliberate, stable, consistent, and tend to be unemotional and poker faced.
- People with Low S scores are described as restless, demonstrative, impatient, eager, or even impulsive.

Conscientious

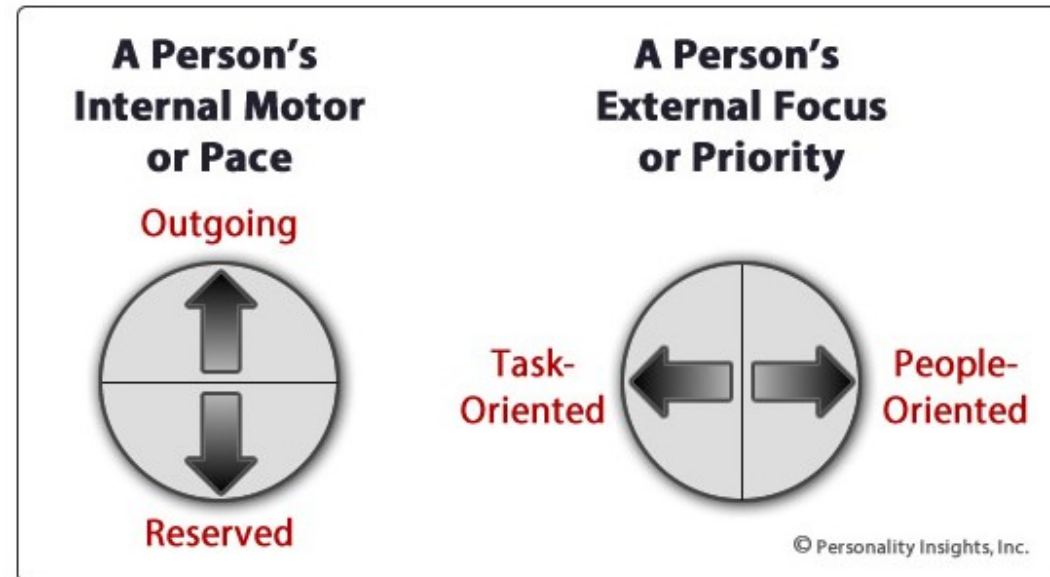
- Persons with High C styles adhere to rules, regulations, and structure.
- They like to do quality work and do it right the first time.
- High C people are careful, cautious, exacting, neat, systematic, diplomatic, accurate, tactful.
- Those with Low C scores challenge the rules and want independence and are described as self-willed, stubborn, opinionated, unsystematic, arbitrary, and careless with details.

DISC Model of Human Behavior

- The DISC Model of Human Behavior is based on 2 foundational observations about how people normally behave:
- **Observation #1: Some people are more OUTGOING, while others are more RESERVED.**
- You can think of this trait as each person's "internal motor" or “pace.” Some people always seem ready to "go" and "dive in" quickly. They engage their motor quickly. Others tend to engage their motor more slowly or more cautiously.
- **Observation # 2: Some people are more TASK-ORIENTED, while others are more PEOPLE-ORIENTED.**
- You can think of this as each person's “external focus” or “priority” that guides them. Some people are focused on getting things done (tasks); others are more tuned-in to the people around them and their feelings.

DISC Model of Human Behavior

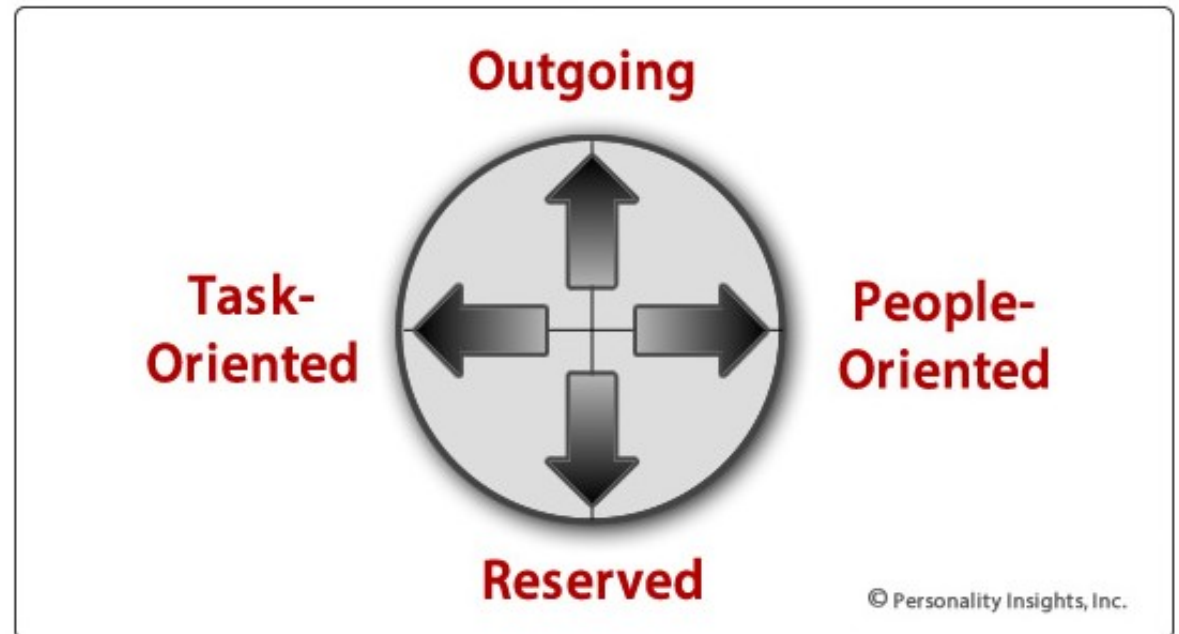
- With both observations, we want to emphasize that these behavioral tendencies are neither right or wrong or good or bad. They are just different.
- We are simply identifying normal behavior styles. People have different styles, and that is okay. We represent these 2 observations in the diagrams below.



DISC Model of Human Behavior

- By combining the 2 previous diagrams, we can show 4 basic quadrants of the circle as shown below:
- Thus, 4 basic personality traits emerge from our diagram corresponding to the 4 quadrants of the circle:
 - Outgoing and Task-oriented (upper left quadrant)
 - Outgoing and People-oriented (upper right quadrant)
 - Reserved and People-oriented (lower right quadrant)
 - Reserved and Task-oriented (lower left quadrant)

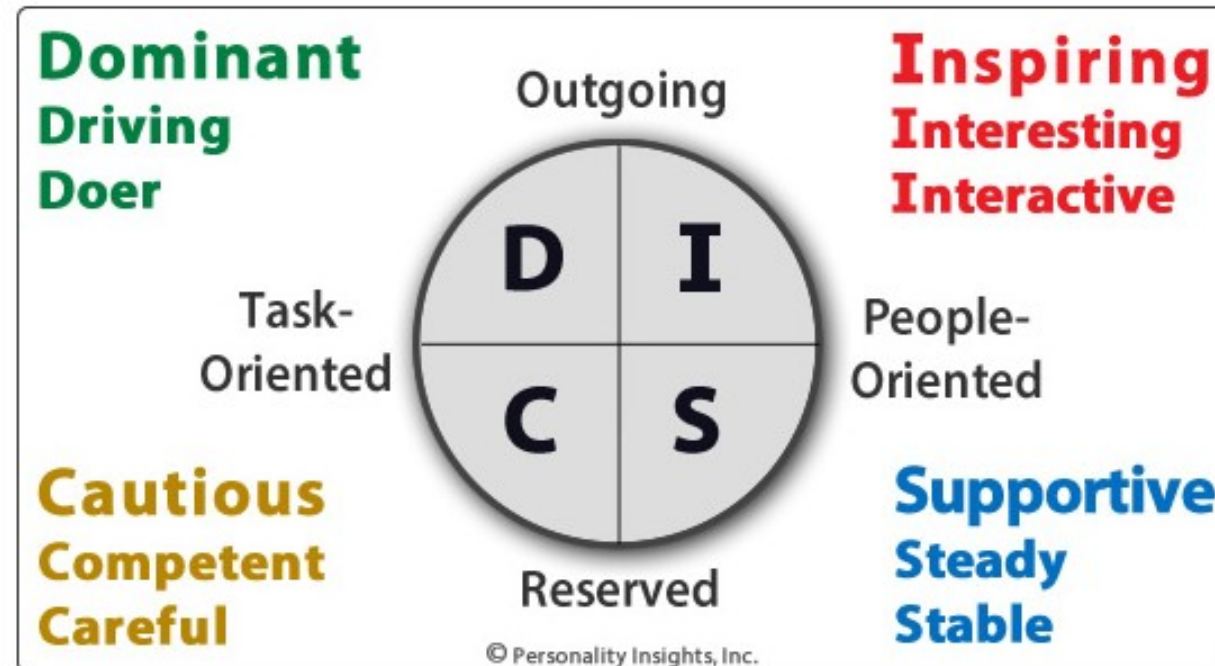
Four Major Personality Traits / Tendencies



DISC Model of Human Behavior

- we will add the descriptive terms to the diagram. Notice the letters D, I, S and C appear in the 4 quadrants of the circle in the diagram below.

D-I-S-C Descriptive Terms



DISC Model of Human Behavior

- Now we can further describe each of the four main personality styles:
- **The Dominant "D" type** - An outgoing, task-oriented individual will be focused on getting things done, accomplishing tasks, getting to the bottom line as quickly as possible and MAKING IT HAPPEN! (The key insight in developing a relationship with this type person is **RESPECT and RESULTS.**)
- **The Inspiring "I" type** - An outgoing, people-oriented individual loves to interact, socialize and have fun. This person is focused on what others may think of him or her. (The key insight in developing a relationship with this type person is **ADMIRATION and RECOGNITION.**)
- **The Supportive "S" type** - A reserved, people-oriented individual will enjoy relationships, helping or supporting other people and working together as a team. (The key insight in developing a relationship with this person is **FRIENDLINESS and SINCERE APPRECIATION.**)
- **The Cautious "C" type** - A reserved, task-oriented individual will seek value, consistency and quality information. This person focuses on being correct and accurate. (The key insight in developing a relationship with this individual is **TRUST and INTEGRITY.**)

DISC Model of Human Behavior

- To summarize the DISC Model of Human Behavior (in clockwise order):
- **D** stands for the **DOMINANT** Type which is **OUTGOING** and **TASK-ORIENTED**.
- **I** stands for the **INSPIRING** Type which is **OUTGOING** and **PEOPLE-ORIENTED**.
- **S** stands for the **SUPPORTIVE** Type which is **RESERVED** and **PEOPLE-ORIENTED**.
- **C** stands for the **CAUTIOUS** Type which is **RESERVED** and **TASK-ORIENTED**.

• DISC Model (somewhat different)

- DISC : Dominance, Influence, Steadiness, Conscientiousness



Dominance

Person places emphasis on accomplishing results, the bottom line, confidence

Behaviors

- Sees the big picture
- Can be blunt
- Accepts challenges
- Gets straight to the point



Influence

Person places emphasis on influencing or persuading others, openness, relationships

Behaviors

- Shows enthusiasm
- Is optimistic
- Likes to collaborate
- Dislikes being ignored



Conscientiousness

Person places emphasis on quality and accuracy, expertise, competency

Behaviors

- Enjoys independence
- Objective reasoning
- Wants the details
- Fears being wrong



Steadiness

Person places emphasis on cooperation, sincerity, dependability

Behaviors

- Doesn't like to be rushed
- Calm manner
- Calm approach
- Supportive actions

DiSC Dominance (D) Profile Overview

People with the D style place an emphasis on shaping the environment by overcoming opposition to accomplish results.

A person with a **D** style

- is motivated by winning, competition and success.
- prioritizes accepting challenges, taking action and achieving immediate results.
- is described as direct, demanding, forceful, strong willed, driven, determined, fast-paced, and self-confident.
- may be limited by lack of concern for others, impatience and open skepticism.
- may fear being seen as vulnerable or being taken advantage of.
- values competency, action, concrete results, personal freedom, and challenges.

DiSC Dominance (D) Profile Overview

Goals:

- unique accomplishments
- new opportunities
- control of audience
- independence

Will need to expend more energy to:

- show patience
- display sensitivity
- get into the details
- allow deliberation

When communicating with D-style individuals, give them the bottom line, be brief, focus your discussion narrowly, avoid making generalizations, refrain from repeating yourself, and focus on solutions rather than problems.

DiSC Classic Patterns: Developer, Results Orientated, Inspirational and Creative

Leadership styles: Commanding, Resolute, Pioneering

DiSC Influence (i) Profile Overview

People the i style place an emphasis on shaping the environment by influencing or persuading others.

A person with an **i** style is motivated by winning, competition and success.

- is described as convincing, magnetic, enthusiastic, warm, trusting and optimistic
- prioritizes taking action, collaboration, and expressing enthusiasm
- is motivated by social recognition, group activities, and relationships
- may fear loss of influence, disapproval and being ignored
- values coaching and counseling, freedom of expression and democratic relationships
- may be limited by being impulsive and disorganized and having lack of follow-through.

DiSC Influence (i) Profile Overview

Goals:

- victory with flair
- friendship and happiness
- authority and prestige status symbols
- popularity

Will need to expend more energy to:

- research all the facts
- speak directly and candidly
- stay focused for long periods
- follow-through completely

When communicating with i-style individuals, share your experiences, allow them time to ask questions and talk themselves. Focus on the positives, avoid overloading them with details, and don't interrupt them.

DiSC Classic Patterns: Promoter, Persuader, Counselor, Appraiser

Leadership styles: Energizing, Pioneering, Affirming

DiSC Steadiness (S) Profile Overview

People with the S style place an emphasis on cooperating with others within existing circumstances to carry out the task.

A person with a **S** style

- is motivated by cooperation, opportunities to help and sincere appreciation
- prioritizes giving support, collaborating and maintaining stability
- is described as calm, patient, predictable, deliberate, stable and consistent
- may be limited by being indecisive, overly accommodating, and a tendency to avoid change
- may fear change, loss of stability, and offending others
- values loyalty, helping others and security.

DiSC Steadiness (S) Profile Overview

Goals:

- personal accomplishments
- group acceptance
- power through formal roles and positions of authority
- maintenance of status quo and controlled environment

Will need to expend more energy to:

- quickly adapt to change or unclear expectations
- multitask
- promote themselves
- confront others

When communicating with S-style individuals, be personal and amiable, express your interest in them and what you expect from them, take time to provide clarification, be polite, and avoid being confrontational, overly aggressive or rude.

DiSC Classic Patterns: specialist, Achiever, Agent, Investigator

Leadership styles: Inclusive, Humble, Affirming

DiSC Conscientiousness (C) Profile Overview

People with the C style place an emphasis on working conscientiously within existing circumstances to ensure quality and accuracy.

A person with a **C** style

- is motivated by opportunities to gain knowledge, show their expertise, and produce quality work
- prioritizes ensuring accuracy, maintaining stability, and challenging assumptions
- is described as careful, cautious, systematic, diplomatic, accurate and tactful
- may be limited by being overcritical, overanalyzing and isolating themselves
- may fear criticism and being wrong
- values quality and accuracy.

DiSC Conscientiousness (C) Profile Overview

Goals:

- objective processes
- correctness
- stability and reliability
- gaining knowledge and expertise
- personal growth

Will need to expend more energy to:

- let go of and delegate tasks
- compromise for the good of the team
- join in social events and celebrations
- make quick decisions

When communicating with C-style individuals, focus on facts and details; minimize "pep talk" or emotional language; be patient, persistent, and diplomatic.

DiSC Classic Patterns: Objective Thinker, Perfectionist, Practitioner

Leadership styles: Deliberate, Humble, Resolute

DISC Model (as a summary)

D is for Dominance	Direct and Decisive. D's are strong willed, strong minded people who like accepting challenges, taking action, and getting immediate results.
I is for influence	Interactive, Optimistic and Outgoing. I's are "people people" who like participating on teams, sharing ideas, and energizing and entertaining others.
S is for Steadiness	Sympathetic and Cooperative. S's are helpful people who like working behind the scenes, performing in consistent and predictable ways, and being good listeners.
C is for Conscientiousness	Concerned and Correct. C's are sticklers for quality and like planning ahead, employing systematic approaches, and checking and re-checking for accuracy.

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Links to DISC Personality Tests

- <https://www.truity.com/test/disc-personality-test>
- <https://www.123test.com/disc-personality-test/>
- <https://www.onlinepersonalitytests.org/disc/>
- <https://www.mydiscprofile.com/free-personality-test.php>
- <https://discpersonalitytesting.com/home/get-a-disc-work-assessment/>
- <https://www.testgorilla.com/test-library/personality-culture-add-tests/disc-test/>
- <https://www.jobtestprep.co.uk/personality-disc-test-prep>
- <https://luztemplates.com/products/disc-profile-test-worksheet-in-excel-4-0>
- <https://cdn.assessments24x7.com/file/assessments24x7-media/reports/DISCselfSampleReport.pdf>



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Thank You very much
for your attention